ERFWeb Signatory Guide

Oct 23, 2026 · @Jay Bryan

Before you start

As a signatory you approve the expense reports of the people your administrator assigned to you. Each report goes through its approvers in order: Level 1 first, then Level 2.

	Level 1	Level 2
Acts	First	After Level 1 approves
Can approve, return, reject	Yes	Yes
Can lower a line amount	Yes, before anyone approves	No
Can override a Level 1 who has not acted	No	Yes
Answers Finance queries	No	Yes

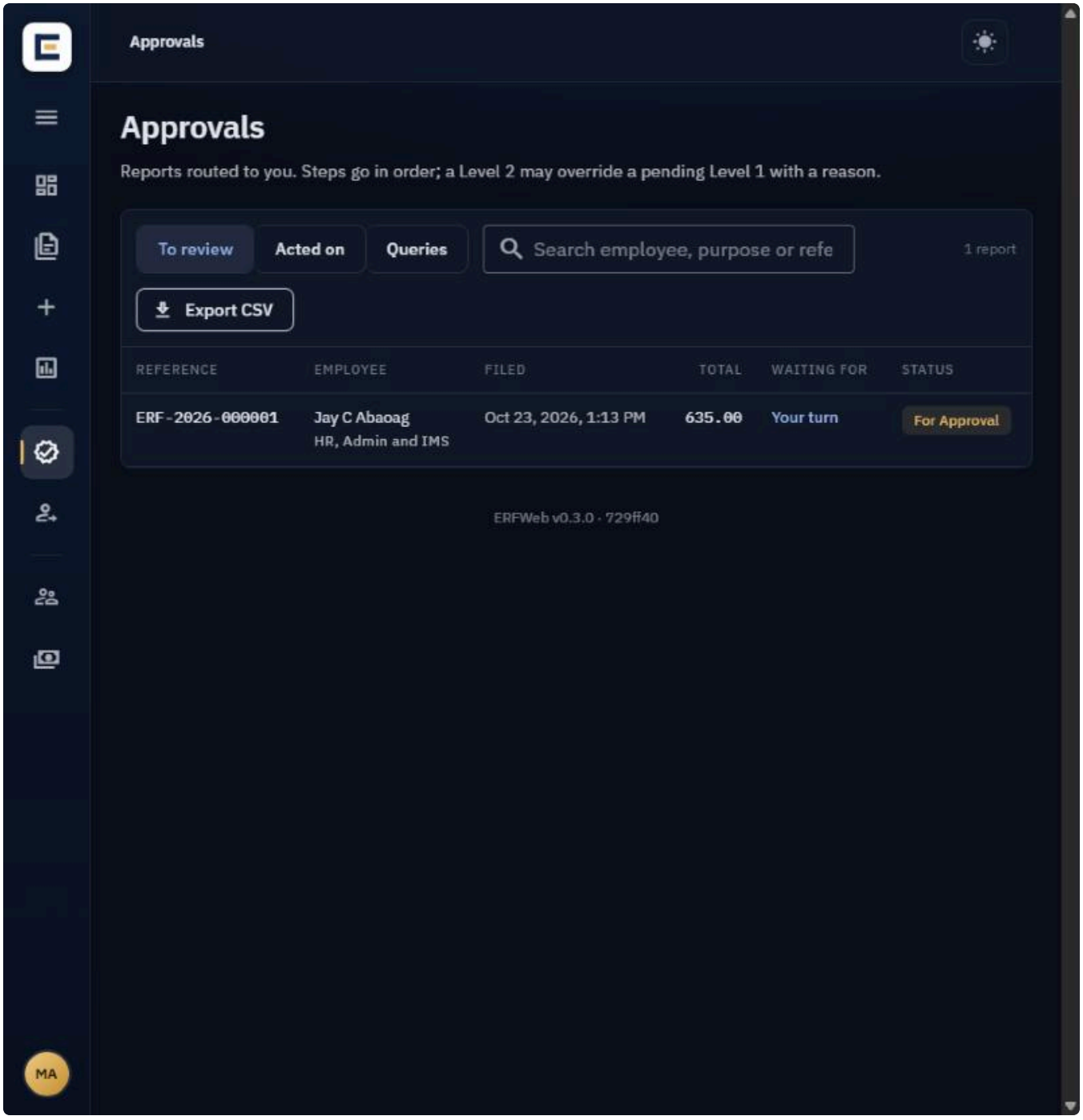
- Sign in to ERFWeb as usual; **Approvals** and **Delegations** appear in your left menu.
- You get an SMS and an email (with the R47 attached) when a report reaches you.
- You never act on your own report. Your own reports go to your own approvers.

Step 1: Find reports waiting for you

Everything routed to you is on the **Approvals** page.

1. In the left menu, click **Approvals**.
2. Pick a tab:
   - **To review**: reports where it is your turn, plus reports still waiting for an earlier approver.
   - **Acted on**: reports you already approved, returned or rejected.
   - **Queries** *(Level 2 only)*: questions from Finance about a line that could not be verified.

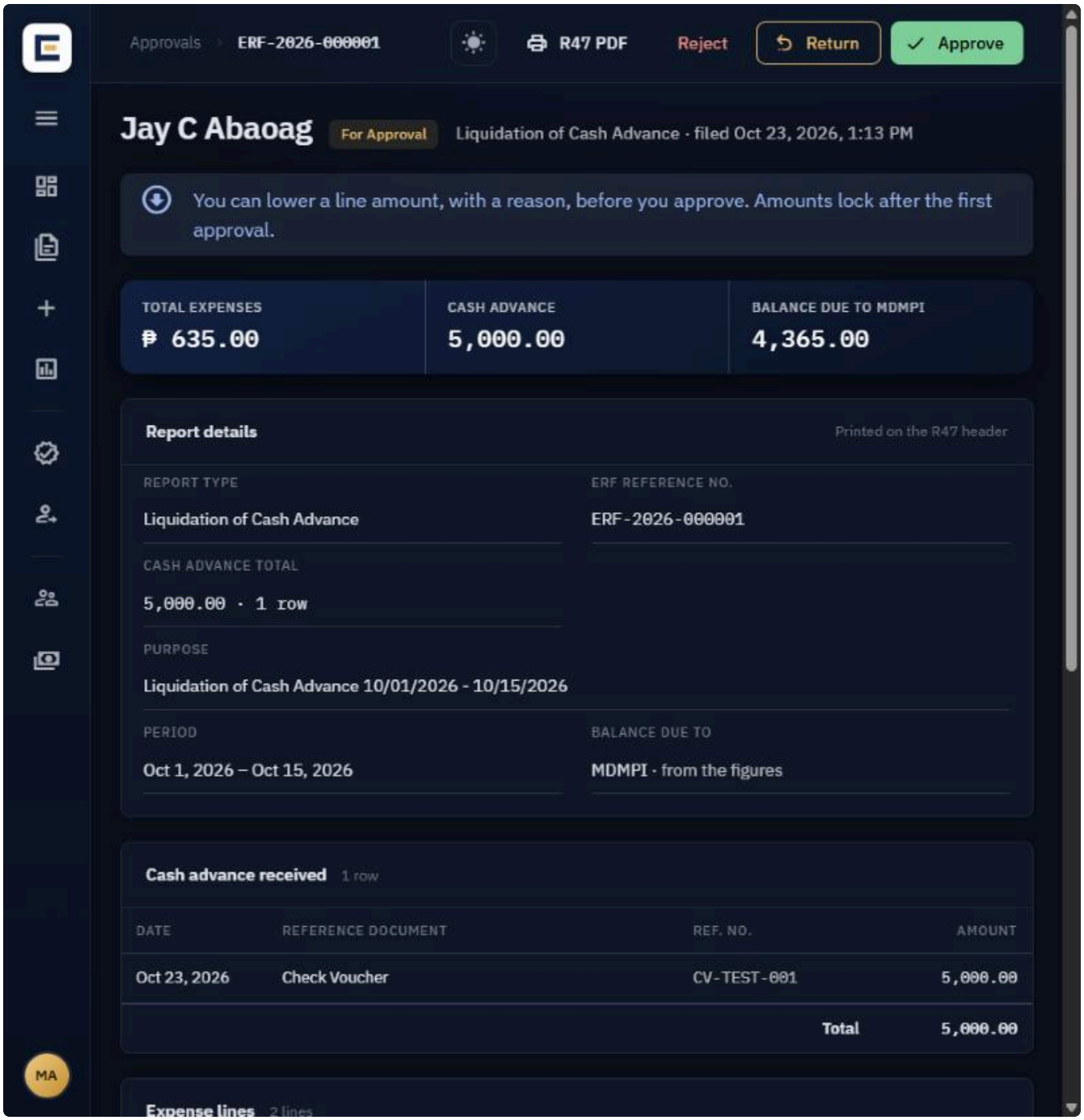
3. To find one report, type the employee's name, the purpose or the ERF reference number in the search box.
4. Click a report to open it.

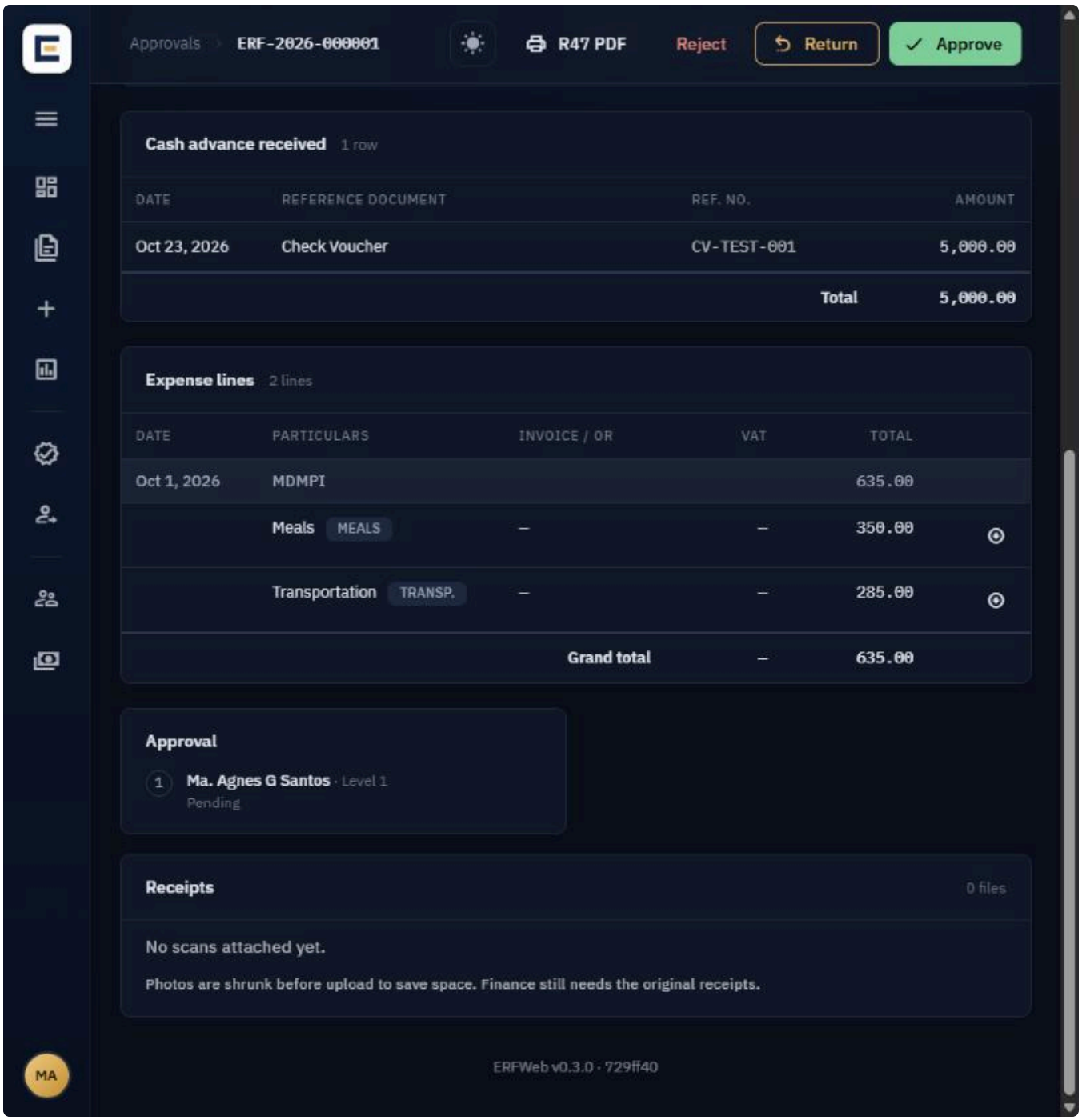


Step 2: Review the report

The review page shows the whole report as the employee filed it; check it before you decide.

1. Read the header: report type, purpose, period and the totals (expenses, cash advance, balance due).
2. Go through the **Expense lines**: date, particulars, the R47 column, VAT and amount. Lines are grouped by date and "Work with".
3. Open the **Receipts** to check the scans match the lines.
4. Check the **approval timeline** to see who has already approved.
5. Click **R47 PDF** to see the printed form.



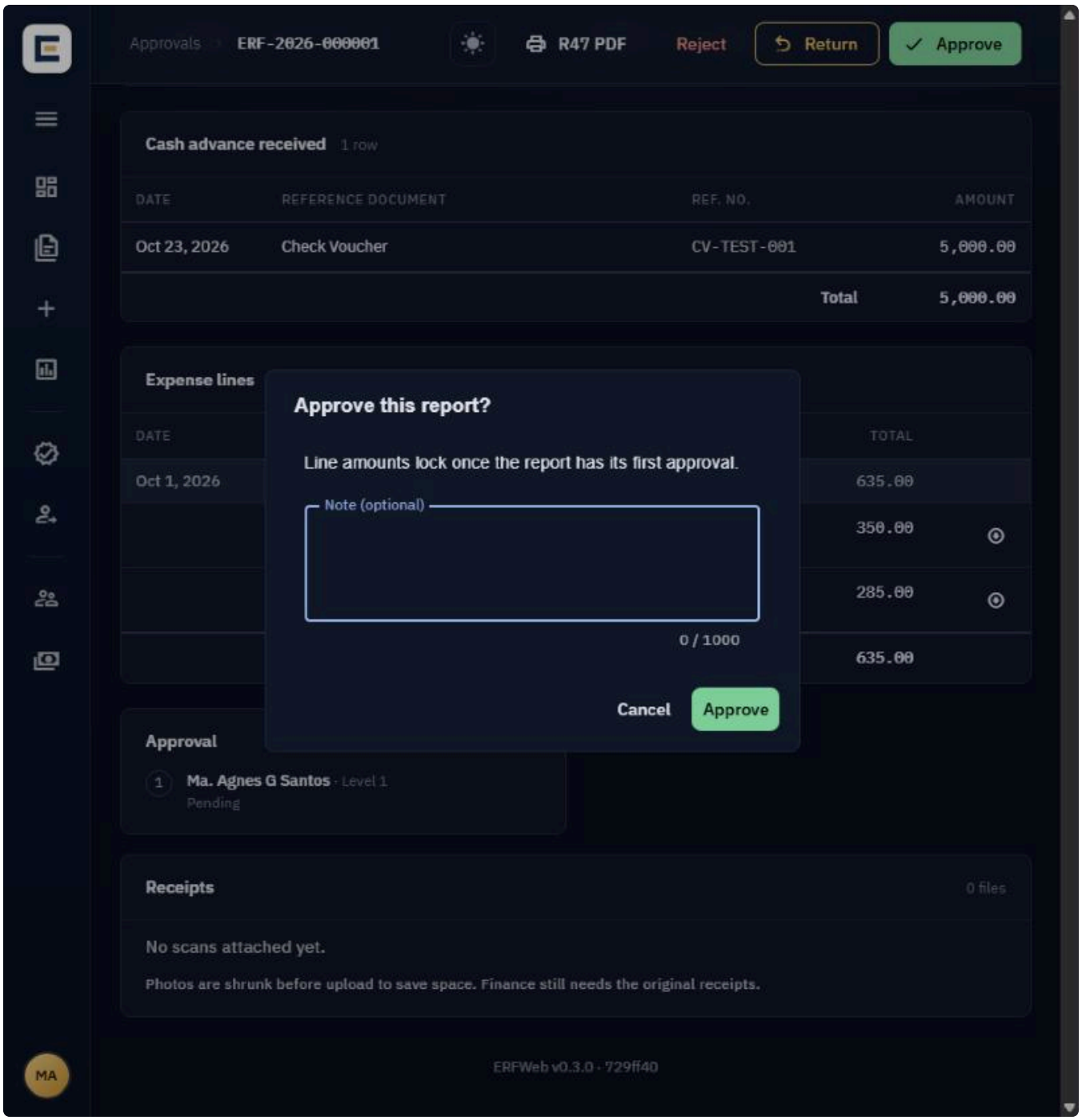


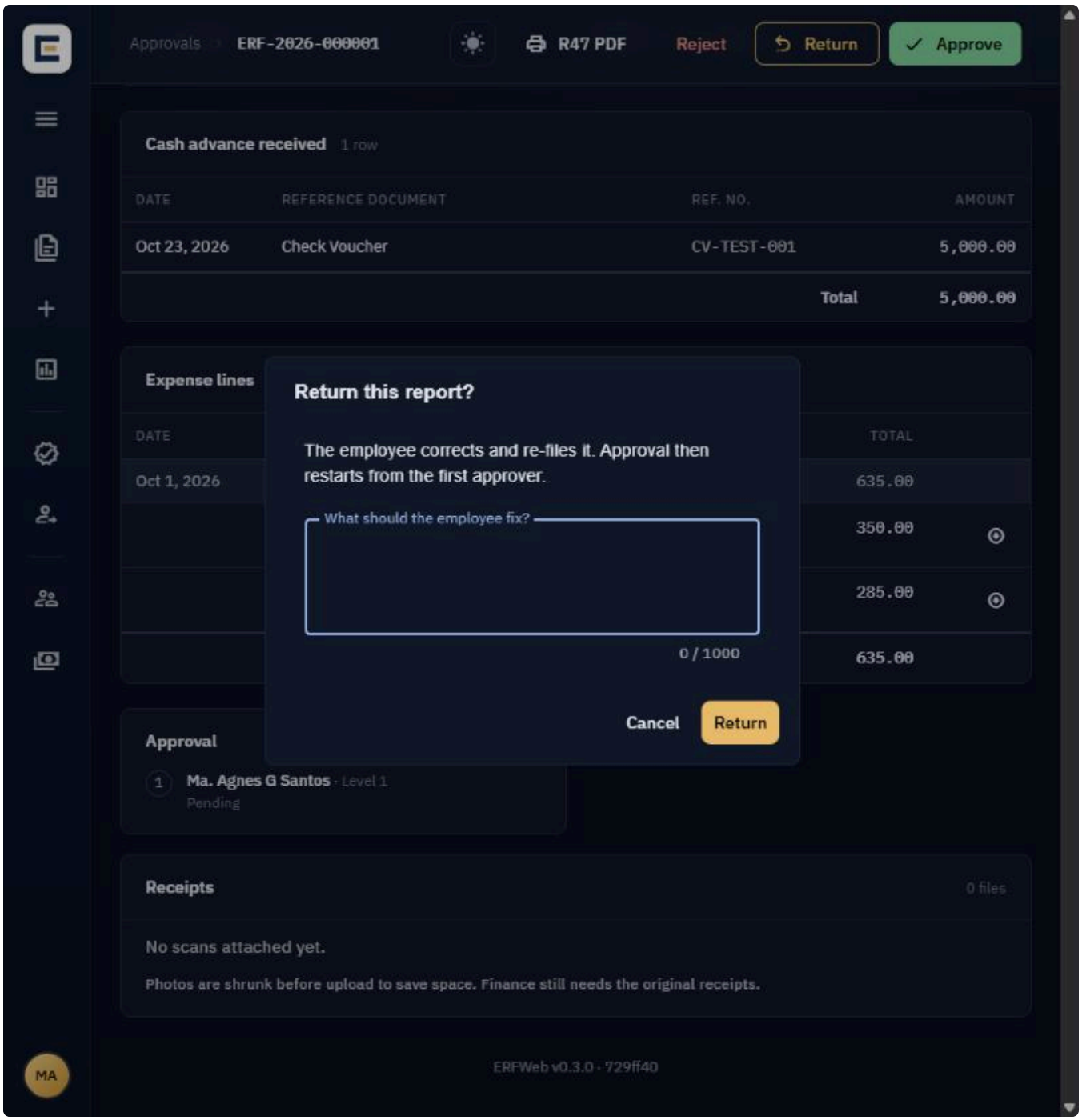
Step 3: Approve, return or reject

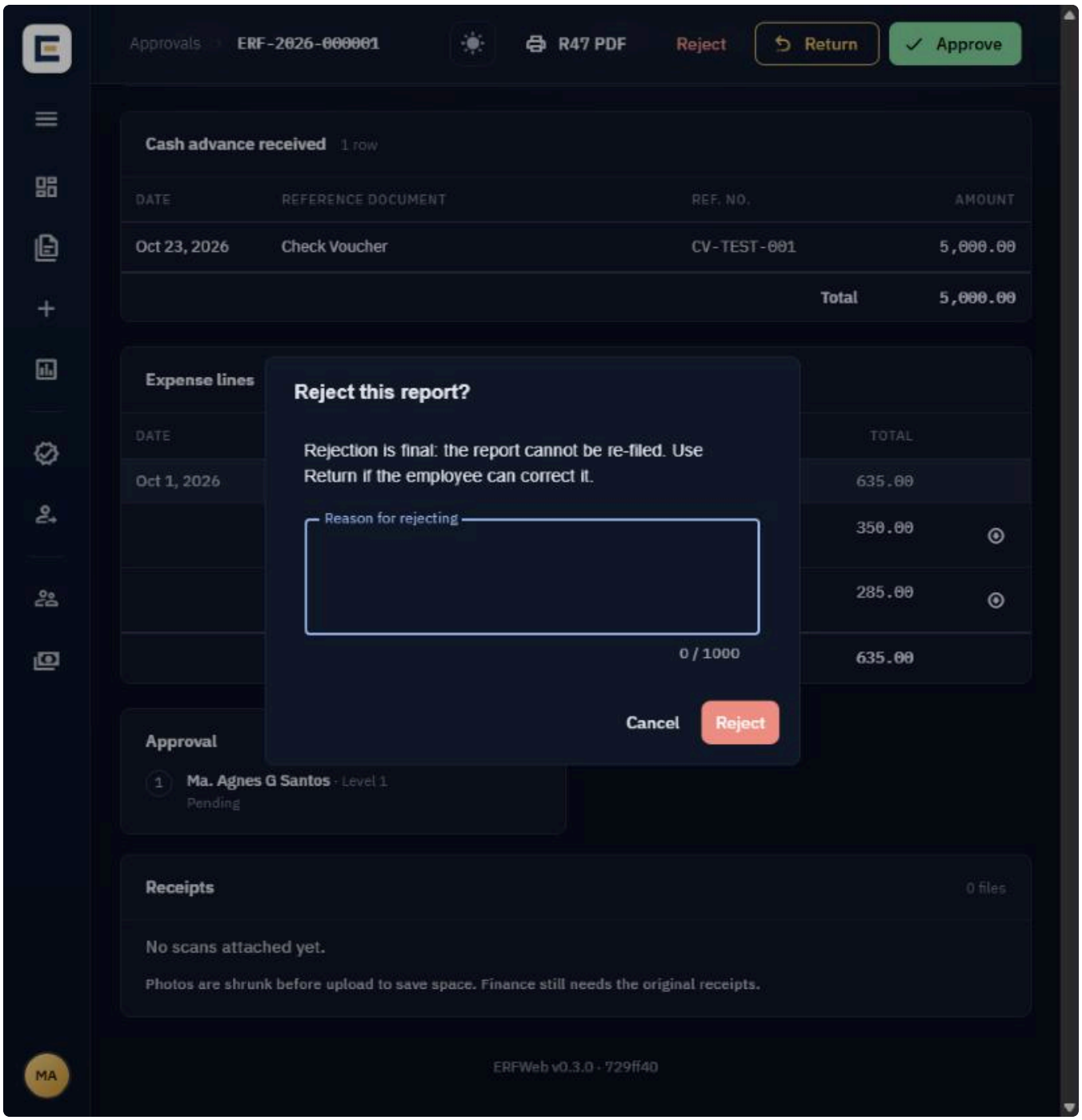
The buttons at the top of the review page show only the actions open to you right now; if none show, it is not your turn yet.

Button	When to use it	What happens	Note
Approve	The report is correct	Goes to the next approver; the last approval sends it to Finance	Optional
Return	The employee can fix it	Goes back to the employee; approval restarts from the first approver when they re-file	Required: what to fix
Reject	It should not be paid at all	Final; it can never be re-filed	Required: the reason

1. Click the button.
2. Read the confirmation and type your note.
3. Click **Approve**, **Return** or **Reject** in the window to confirm.


Approvals
ERF-2026-000001
R47 PDF
Reject
Return
Approve
Cash advance received
1 row
DATE
REFERENCE DOCUMENT
REF. NO.
AMOUNT
Oct 23, 2026
Check Voucher
CV-TEST-001
5,000.00
Total
5,000.00
Expense lines
DATE
TOTAL
Oct 1, 2026
635.00
350.00
285.00
635.00
Approve this report?
Line amounts lock once the report has its first approval.
Note (optional)
0 / 1000
Cancel
Approve
Approval
1
Ma. Agnes G Santos · Level 1
Pending
Receipts
0 files
No scans attached yet.
Photos are shrunk before upload to save space. Finance still needs the original receipts.
MA
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Approvals
ERF-2026-000001
R47 PDF
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5,000.00
Expense lines
DATE
TOTAL
Oct 1, 2026
635.00
350.00
285.00
635.00
Return this report?
The employee corrects and re-files it. Approval then restarts from the first approver.
What should the employee fix?
0 / 1000
Cancel
Return
Approval
1
Ma. Agnes G Santos · Level 1
Pending
Receipts
0 files
No scans attached yet.
Photos are shrunk before upload to save space. Finance still needs the original receipts.
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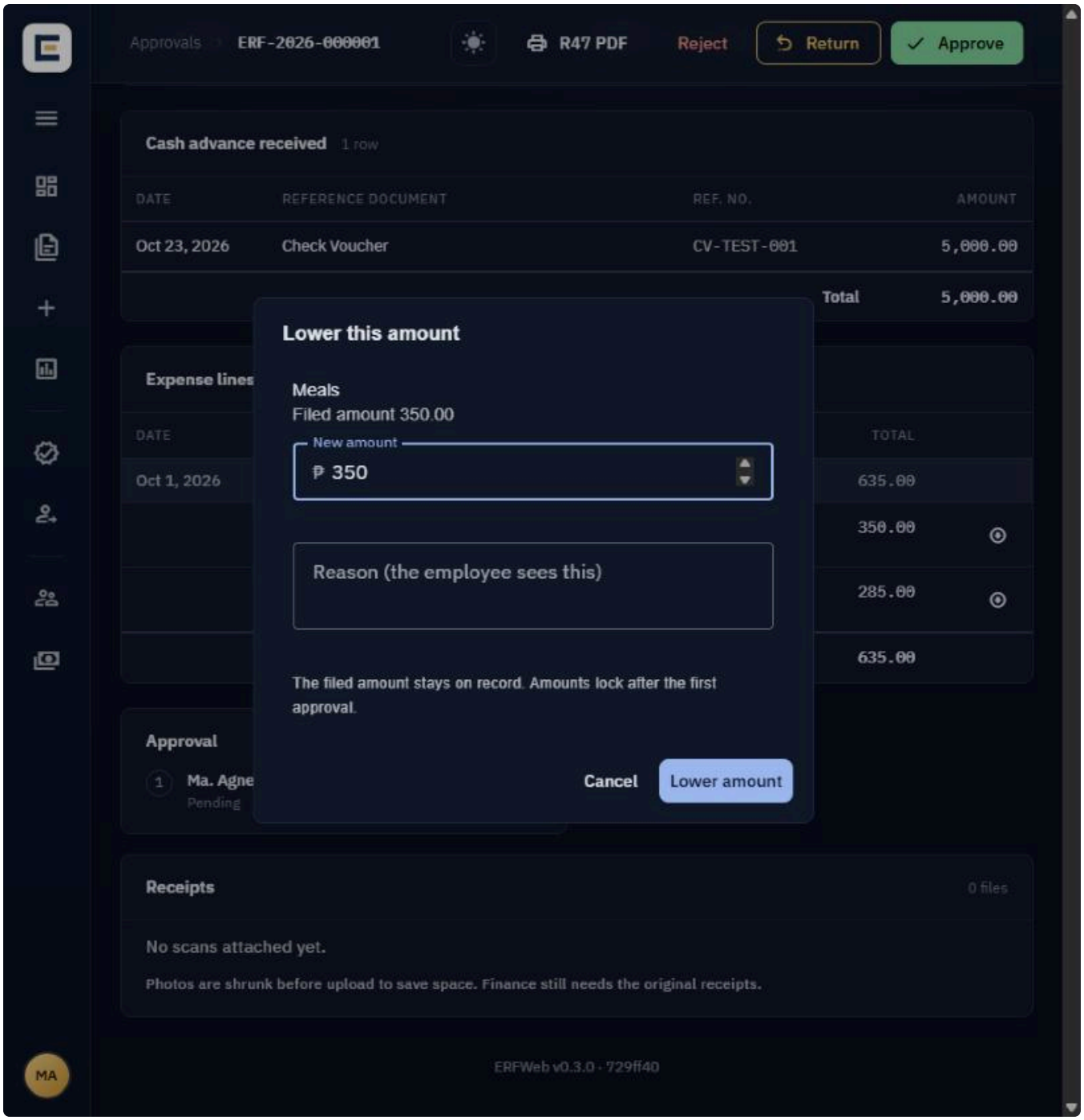


The employee and the other approvers get an SMS and an email; your note is quoted in them. Line amounts lock once the report has its first approval. Use **Return**, not Reject, whenever the employee can correct the report.

Level 1 only: Lower a line amount

If one expense is too high, a Level 1 can lower it instead of returning the whole report, but only before anyone approves.

1. In the **Expense lines**, click the **Lower amount** icon (a down arrow) on the line.
2. In **Lower this amount**, enter the **New amount**; it must be lower than the filed amount.
3. Enter the **Reason**; the employee sees it.
4. Click **Lower amount**, then approve the report as usual.



The filed amount stays on record and everyone sees both figures. You cannot raise an amount; return the report instead.

Level 2 only: Override and Finance queries

A Level 2 can move a stuck report past an absent Level 1, and decides on lines Finance could not verify.

Override a pending Level 1

1. Open the report from **To review** while it still waits for its Level 1.
2. Click **Override**.
3. In **Approve without the Level 1?**, explain why, then click **Override and approve**.

The Level 1 step is marked *Overridden* and the report is approved; your reason is kept in the audit trail. If the Level 1 is only away for a while, a delegation (next section) is usually better.

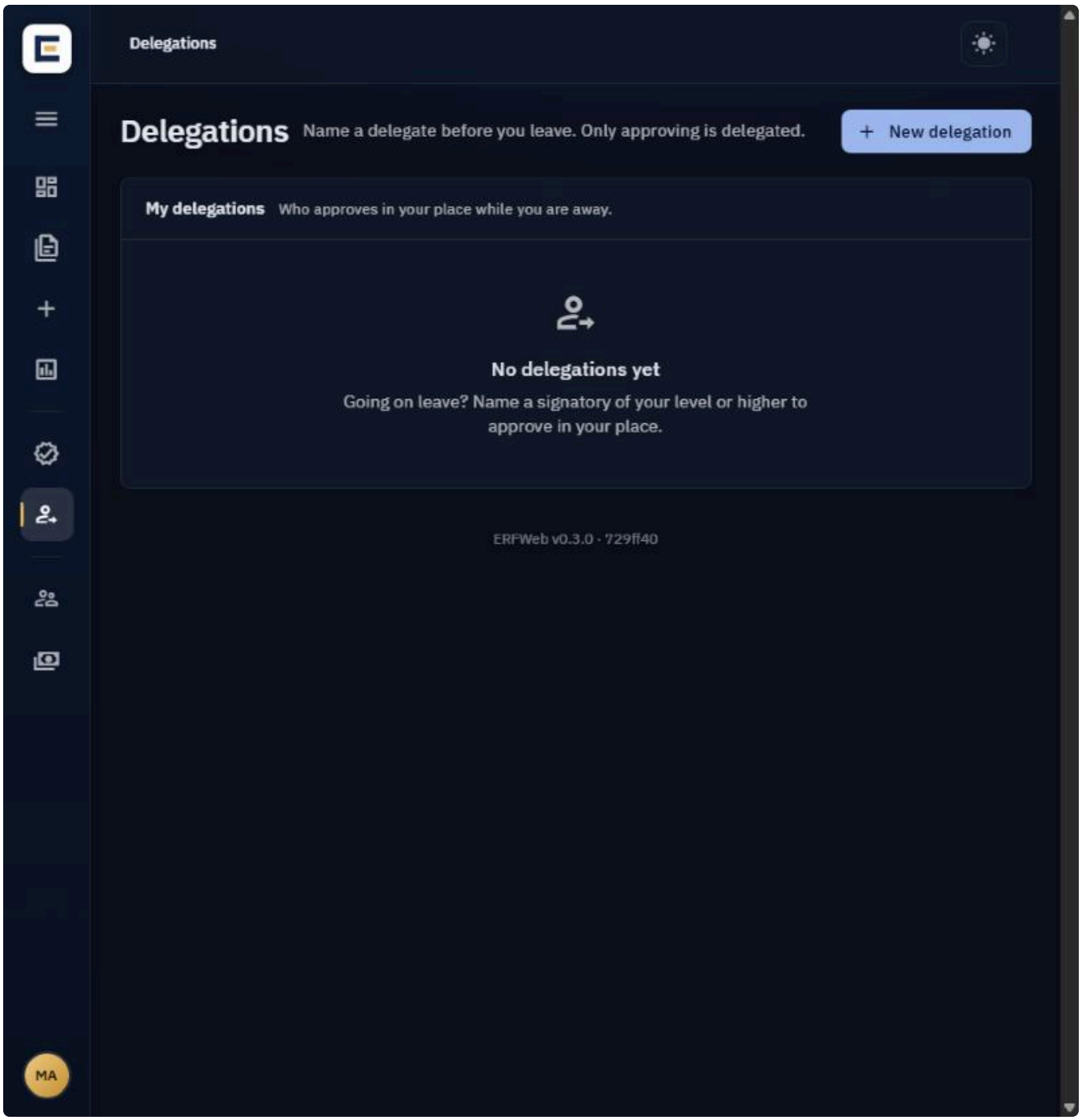
Answer a Finance query

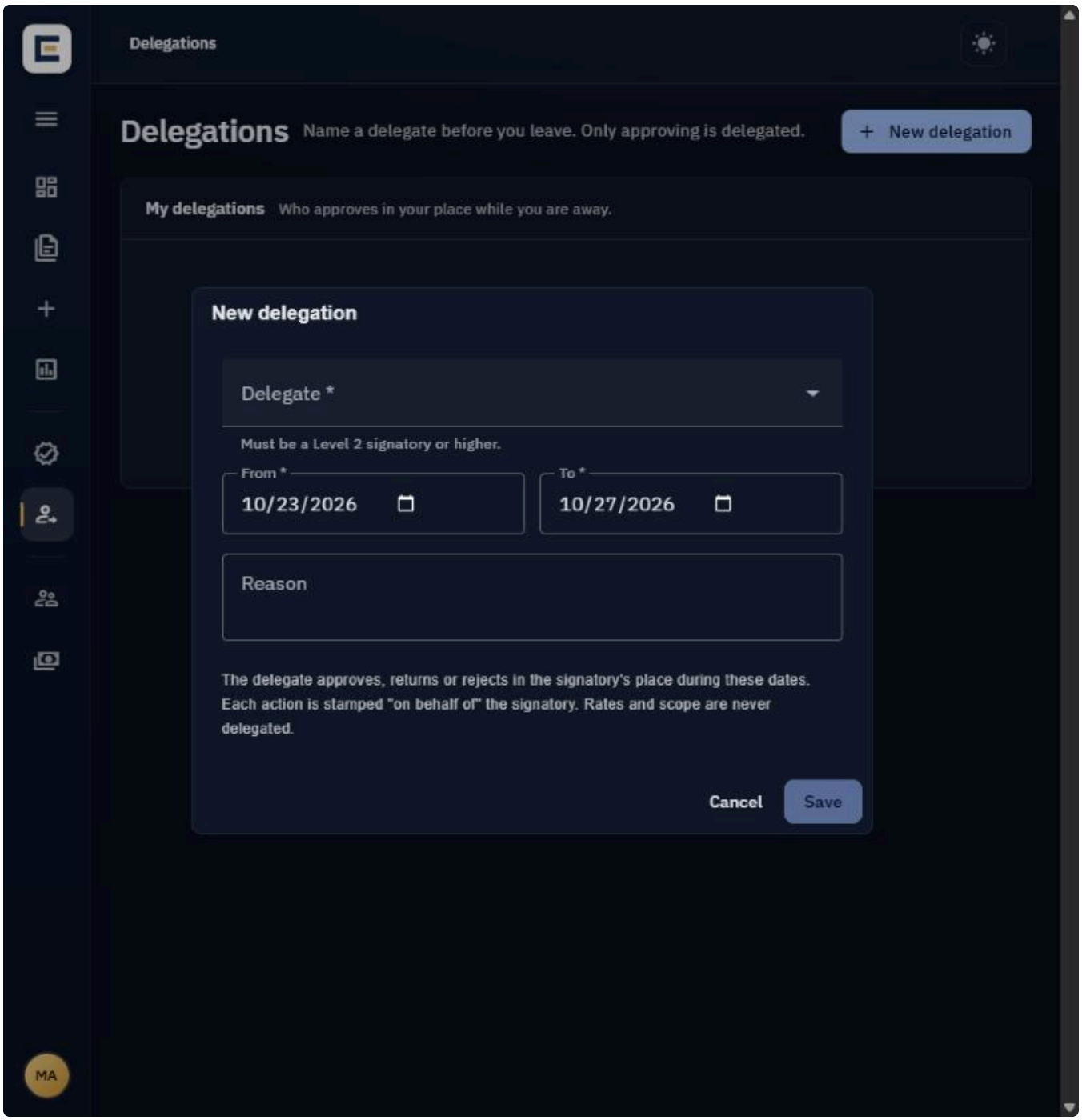
1. Open the **Queries** tab in **Approvals** and click the report.
2. Read the line in question and the verifier's finding in the **Verification** card.
3. Choose one:
   - **Let it through**: Finance carries on and can clear the report.
   - **Return for correction**: the employee corrects and re-files; approval restarts. A note is required.
   - **Reject the report**: final; it cannot be re-filed. A note is required.
4. Confirm. Answered queries move to *Decided*.

Going on leave: Set up a delegation

Name a delegate before you leave so reports don't wait for you; only approving is delegated, never rates or scope.

1. In the left menu, click **Delegations**, then **New delegation**.
2. If the window shows **Whose approvals**, choose **Mine**. That choice appears only for a Level 2 who is over Level 1s: pick **A Level 1 I am over** when one of them is away and left no delegate, then pick the **Level 1 signatory**.
3. Pick the **Delegate**: a signatory of your level or higher.
4. Set **From** and **To** (at most 90 days) and an optional **Reason**, e.g. *On leave*.
5. Click **Save**.


Delegations
Delegations
Name a delegate before you leave. Only approving is delegated.
+ New delegation
My delegations
Who approves in your place while you are away.
No delegations yet
Going on leave? Name a signatory of your level or higher to approve in your place.
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During those dates the delegate approves, returns or rejects for you, and each step reads "on behalf of" you. The R47 prints the delegate's own signature. To end it early, click **Cancel** on the delegation, then **Cancel delegation**.

Exports and common problems

Export CSV on the Approvals page downloads the current tab and search as a spreadsheet. **Summary** in the left menu totals the expenses of the reports you approve, as CSV or PDF.

What you see	What to do
A report is in **To review** but has no Approve button	It is waiting for an earlier approver
The page reloads after you click a button	Someone acted at the same moment; check the timeline and act again if it is still your turn
The **Lower amount** icon is missing	Only the Level 1 sees it, and only before the first approval
An employee asks you to change an approved report	Ask them to have it returned; approved amounts are locked
You want to approve but you are the employee on it	You can't; your own reports go to your own approvers
A report from someone outside your team appears, or one is missing	Ask your administrator to check your scope